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Craft mastery: Dilip Doshi, known for his classical left-arm action, took 114 Test wickets in 33 matches and claimed 22 more in 15 ODIs. He also played First-Class cricket for Saurashtra, Bengal, Warwickshire, and Nottinghamshire. GETTY IMAGES



Archival moment: East Zone captain Dilip Doshi receives the runner-up trophy from the then BCCI president after the Duleep Trophy final in Bombay, November 8, 1981. THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

cricketer”.

In his post-retirement life, he entered the corporate world and famously introduced Mont Blanc pens to India in the 1990s. But cricket was never far. He had a star-studded circle — Rolling Stones

lead songwriter and vocalist Mick Jagger, former West Indies captain Garfield Sobers, former Pakistan skipper Zaheer Abbas among them — but lived simply.

Whenever in India, he'd visit his hometown Rajkot and quietly watch domestic matches at the Niranjn Shah Stadium. "This gives me immense satisfaction," he once told me during a Ranji Trophy quarterfinal between Saurashtra and Punjab.

His warmth drew people to him. Sachin Tendulkar recalled their first meeting — in England, 1990. Doshi, already retired, bowled to Tendulkar in the nets. "He was really fond of me, and I reciprocated his feelings. A warm-hearted soul like Dilip-*bhai* will be deeply missed. I will miss those cricketing conversations which we invariably had," Tendulkar wrote on social media.

The cricket fraternity will long remember his five-wicket haul in the 1981 Melbourne Test — achieved while playing with a broken toe. "I'd apply electrodes every evening to manage the swelling," he once told me. "It was a crucial game — I couldn't miss it."

Off the pitch, he enjoyed Jagger's company. The two watched cricket